

Sample Employer, Inc. | Sample PBM, Inc.

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DSI DESIGNATION

INELIGIBLE

FLOOR FAILURE

DATA SOVEREIGNTY

Depth of employer control across the five dimensions that decide who controls the data.

The Data Sovereignty score measures contract strength on five high-leverage provisions: rebate transparency, data ownership, audit rights, conflict of interest, and lowest net cost. Designation requires two independent conditions. Every one of the five provisions must clear a 60-point floor. And the Fiduciary Alignment Score must clear the tier threshold to achieve Bronze, Silver, or Gold status. Either condition's failure produces an INELIGIBLE result.

DESIGNATION CRITERIA

CONDITION 1: PER-PROVISION FLOOR

FAILED

All five DSI provisions must score 60 or above.

Result: 4 of 5 pass. P5 Audit Rights & Verification (38) falls below the 60-point floor. A single floor failure disqualifies the contract from any DSI designation. The path to improvement is described in the Negotiation and Remediation reports.

CONDITION 2: FIDUCIARY ALIGNMENT SCORE

BELOW SILVER

DSI Gold requires FAS at or above 90. DSI Silver requires FAS at or above 75.

FAS
ACTUAL **59** /100 **CONCERN**

Result: FAS of 59 is below the Silver threshold of 75. Even with all five floors cleared, the contract would qualify only for DSI Bronze at this FAS.

DSI PROVISION FLOORS

P3
Rebate & Manufacturer Revenue

62 **PASS**

0 FLOOR 60 100

P4
Data Ownership & Rights

64 **PASS**

0 FLOOR 60 100

P5
Audit Rights & Verification

38 **FAIL**

0 FLOOR 60 100

P6
Conflict of Interest & Neutrality

80 **PASS**

0 FLOOR 60 100

P8
Lowest Net Cost & Clinical Integrity

60 **PASS**

0 FLOOR 60 100

WHY INELIGIBLE

P5 Audit Rights & Verification scores 38, below the 60-point per-provision floor. One floor failure disqualifies the contract from any DSI designation regardless of the other four provisions. Remediation of audit access alone would clear the floor and qualify the contract for DSI Bronze.

About this report. This report is provided for informational and educational purposes only. It does not constitute legal, financial, or professional advice. Scores reflect explicit contract language. They do not evaluate business practices, marketing claims, regulatory filings, or operational performance outside the documents reviewed. Plan sponsors should consult qualified counsel before incorporating any model language into a binding agreement.

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01

How DSI designations work

Four tiers. Two conditions. Both must be met.

DSI uses four designation tiers, with two independent qualifying conditions. Neither condition compensates for the other: a strong overall score cannot mask a weak provision, and a perfect floor cannot lift an average score.

DESIGNATION	FAS THRESHOLD	PER-PROVISION FLOOR
DSI Gold	FAS ≥ 90 (Excellent)	All five floors ≥ 75 (Good)
DSI Silver	FAS ≥ 75 (Good)	All five floors ≥ 60 (Fair)
DSI Bronze	No FAS minimum	All five floors ≥ 60 (Fair)
Ineligible	n/a	Any one floor below 60

The two-condition design exists because data sovereignty is a structural property of a contract, not an average. A single weak provision creates a hole large enough to compromise sponsor control regardless of strength elsewhere. The per-provision floor protects against that masking effect.

02

The LEED parallel

Built on a pattern that works.

DSI is structured after the LEED certification system for buildings, a model that has reshaped construction practice over twenty-five years. Three design choices carry over.

INDEPENDENT THIRD-PARTY SCORING

LEED is awarded by the US Green Building Council, not by builders. DSI is awarded by Nautilus Health Institute, not by PBMs. Independence is the foundation of the designation's credibility.

MEANINGFUL TIER DIFFERENTIATION

LEED has Certified, Silver, Gold, and Platinum. DSI has Bronze, Silver, and Gold. Both reject the binary pass-fail framing. A Silver-rated contract is genuinely different from a Bronze-rated contract.

DESIGNED TO EVOLVE OVER TIME

LEED has tightened its criteria across versions as the industry has matured. DSI is built with the same expectation. What earns Gold today may be the floor for Silver in a future version.

Like LEED, DSI rewards demonstrated contract structure rather than aspirational marketing claims. The designation is earned through what the PBM has agreed to in writing, not what is said in pitch materials.

03

Using DSI in procurement

Three ways plan sponsors apply the designation.

The DSI is most valuable when it changes a decision. Three patterns emerge from plan sponsors who use it well.

1

SET A MINIMUM TIER IN RFP SCORING

Many sponsors require DSI Silver or higher as a baseline qualifier in pharmacy-benefit RFPs. This filters proposals on contract structure before evaluating pricing or operational fit. It also signals to incumbents that data sovereignty is non-negotiable.

2

MEASURE TIER PROGRESS YEAR OVER YEAR

A DSI Bronze contract is not a failure. It is a starting point with a visible improvement path. Sponsors who re-score at each renewal create documented progress: Bronze to Silver, Silver to Gold. The designation becomes a fiduciary record, not just a moment-in-time snapshot.

3

TRANSLATE THE DESIGNATION FOR THE BOARD

The board does not need to understand the per-provision floor mechanics to engage with the designation. A short summary works: this contract meets (or does not meet) DSI Silver criteria, which means the plan sponsor can (or cannot) demonstrate that data sovereignty protections exist in writing across all five dimensions.

This DSI report places **Sample Employer, Inc.**'s Sample PBM, Inc. contract at the **Ineligible** level. Whether that becomes a target to maintain, a baseline to improve, or a reason to renegotiate is the sponsor's decision to make.

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